DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

CSE0001 — Digital Literacy

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Introduction

So this report is basically a record of everything I did for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project at VIT Bhopal. For this assignment, I was kind of playing the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — which basically means helping fellow students figure out how to use the internet safely and professionally.

The whole project is split into five tasks, and each one connects to a different module from the course. I had to make an infographic, set up some online profiles, try out a coding platform, write professional emails, and then look into cybercrime. Sounds like a lot, but honestly it was pretty manageable once I got started.

All the files and work I've done are in a GitHub repository, which is itself part of what we had to submit. This report just goes through each task — what I did, which tools I used, and what I actually took away from it. Everything here is my own work and written in my own words.

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used & What I Created

For this one I used Canva — it's free, browser-based, and you don't need any design background to use it. I made a single-page infographic called 'Digital Literacy: Your Guide to the Online World.' Canva has loads of templates so it's pretty easy to get started even if you've never designed anything before.

My infographic ended up covering three main topics. First, what digital literacy actually means — basically the ability to find, evaluate, create and communicate stuff using digital tools. Second, safe internet habits like using strong passwords, turning on two-factor authentication, and double-checking sources before you share anything. And third, having a professional online presence — stuff like keeping your LinkedIn and GitHub profiles up to date because that's basically your digital identity to the outside world.

Reflection

Honestly the most interesting thing I found while making this was just how broad digital literacy actually is. I kind of assumed it just meant being decent with technology, but it's way more than that — it includes how you think critically about information, how you communicate online, and how you present yourself professionally. The hardest part was figuring out what NOT to include, because there's genuinely a lot of important stuff and fitting it all on one page meant I had to make some tough choices. I think this task basically taught me that good communication isn't about cramming in everything you know — it's about picking the right things and saying them clearly.

Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

I created accounts on three platforms for this task — GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

- GitHub (github.com) — This is mainly for storing and sharing code and projects. I set up a profile README with my name, branch, year, and a bit about what I'm hoping to learn.
- LinkedIn (linkedin.com) — Pretty much the go-to platform for professional networking. I filled in my education details — degree, college, and expected graduation year.
- Kaggle (kaggle.com) — It's a data science and machine learning platform. I made an account so I can start exploring datasets and notebooks as I get better at programming.

Reflection

Setting all this up made me realise something I hadn't really thought about before — you should be building your digital presence from day one of college, not scrambling to do it in your final year when you're applying for jobs. GitHub is where my coding journey will basically live, LinkedIn is how the professional world will find me, and Kaggle is where I'll probably practice data stuff once I've learned more Python.

What actually surprised me was how fast it all came together. I had profiles on all three platforms within an hour or so. The harder part is going to be keeping them updated and actually active over the next four years. My plan is to push at least one new project to GitHub per semester and update LinkedIn whenever I finish a course or get an internship.

Task 3 — Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A — HackerRank (Coding Practice)

I signed up on HackerRank and completed the 'Solve Me First' challenge along with the Python Hello World one. These are pretty much the most beginner-friendly problems on the platform — they're basically there just to make sure your code runs and compiles properly. What I liked about HackerRank is that it shows you the test cases and tells you exactly which ones failed, so you can actually figure out where you went wrong instead of just getting a vague 'incorrect' message.

Part B — Google Forms (Collaboration Tool)

I built a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. It's got four multiple-choice questions covering things like password safety, UPI scams, and which platform is best for certain things, plus one short-answer question where

students have to name a cybercrime prevention tip. The form automatically feeds responses into a Google Sheet, which is actually really convenient.

Reflection

Both of these platforms are more useful than they might seem at first. HackerRank gave me a decent idea of how online judges work — like, this is literally the same type of system companies use in coding interviews. That was kind of eye-opening for a first-year student. And Google Forms — I've used it before for random surveys but building an actual quiz with scoring and a live response sheet was new to me. The fact that a form I made in 20 minutes can collect and sort data from hundreds of people automatically is honestly impressive. I'll definitely be using both of these again — HackerRank when I'm learning data structures, and Forms for any project where I need to collect responses.

Task 4 — Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Email Drafts Summary

I wrote two professional emails for this task. The first one is a student emailing their professor to ask for a deadline extension. It has a proper subject line with the course name and reg number, a decent greeting, a clear reason for the request, a suggested new deadline, and a clean sign-off. Nothing too fancy but it follows all the right conventions.

The second one is a student reaching out to an internship coordinator to express interest in a summer internship. It introduces the person, briefly mentions relevant skills, and says a resume is attached — all kept pretty confident but humble, which I think is the right tone for someone who's still in their first year.

Scenario — Poor Digital Communication

There was this incident in 2021 where a student posted some pretty harsh criticism of their professor publicly on social media — used their name and everything. What started as a genuine academic complaint blew up into a whole public mess. The student ended up in a disciplinary hearing, and the professor got trolled by random people online who had nothing to do with it. The thing is, if the student had just sent a polite private email, the same concern could have been addressed without any of that drama. It's a good example of how the platform and tone you choose can completely change the outcome of a situation — even when your original concern is valid.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

I chose to research UPI fraud for this task, mostly because it's one of the most common scams targeting college students in India right now. The way it usually works is the fraudster convinces the victim to either approve a fake 'collect money' request on their UPI app, or tricks them into sharing their OTP by pretending to be a bank official, a buyer on OLX, or sometimes even a job recruiter. Once the transaction goes through, the money moves across multiple accounts really fast, which makes it almost impossible to recover.

Reflection

Honestly what surprised me the most was just how low-tech most of these frauds actually are. These people aren't hacking into systems or writing malware or anything like that — they're just manipulating people. It's literally just a phone call, some fake urgency, and getting someone confused enough to enter their PIN at the wrong moment. No complex technical skill required at all.

The one habit I'm going to change after this is adding a deliberate pause before doing anything financial that was triggered by a call or message. Like if someone is rushing me to do something with money — that's exactly the moment I should slow down. That's basically the whole trick these scammers rely on.

Conclusion

Looking back, this was probably one of the more practically useful things I've done in college so far. Like, setting up a GitHub repository, making an infographic, writing proper emails, and researching cybercrime — none of this is theoretical stuff that I'll forget after the exam. These are actual skills I'll keep using.

The biggest thing I'm taking away is that digital literacy isn't really one skill — it's more of a mindset. It's about thinking before you click, communicating with the right tone on the right platform, and being aware of what's happening around you online. I'm finishing this project with an actual GitHub portfolio, accounts on three professional platforms, and a much better understanding of the risks that exist online. That feels like a decent start.

References

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